

ENGLISH 8 · SELLI PRACTICE MATERIAL

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SELLI mock · Units 1–2

Load-Bearing Structures · Clauses Within Clauses — SELLI format, not graded

Name: _____

Expediente: _____ Group: _____

Date: _____ Time: 85 minutes

SCORE

/ 81

practice only — does not count

Instructions. This is a **practice test in SELLI format**, restricted to Units 1–2. It does not count towards your grade; what it gives you is a map of what to review. Circle **one** letter only; an item with two marks scores zero. No dictionaries. **There is no penalty for guessing**, so never leave a blank. Budget **40 seconds per item** in Sections B and C, and about **25 minutes** for Section D. Section A is paced by the recording: it is played **one time only** and it does not stop. When you finish, use the profile sheet on the last page before you look at any answer.

SECTION A · Listening comprehension**16 pts · 1 each**

You will **hear** the conversations and the questions; only the four options are printed. Everything is played **one time only** and the recording does not stop: you have 12 seconds after each question.

💡 How this section works

Part A (1–12). Two people speak, then a third voice asks a question. **Part B (13–16).** One longer conversation, then four questions.

What is tested here is the **same grammar as the rest of the exam**, heard instead of read: the connector, the clause, the number. The right answer almost always **rephrases** what a structure implies; the wrong ones repeat words you heard or reverse the relation the connector marks.

Example. You hear — **M:** *Did the supplier send the revised drawings, or the cost breakdown?* **W:** *Neither one arrived, nor did anyone answer the phone.* **N:** *What does the woman mean?* You read: a) Only the drawings were sent. b) Nothing was received and no one replied. c) The cost breakdown arrived first. d) The supplier answered the phone. — **b** is right: *neither... nor* negates both things at once (G1).

Part A — questions 1–12.

- a) She has heard nothing about the money or the flight.
 - b) Both answers reached her later than she had expected.
 - c) The department got back to her, but the sponsor never did.
 - d) The sponsor agreed to pay, but the department refused.
- a) The supervisor found him working at his desk instead.
 - b) He avoided the briefing so that he could save the files.
 - c) Missing the briefing is what made his files start failing.
 - d) The failing files are what kept him from the briefing.
- a) The systems office will back up the drives.
 - b) The old servers will stop running for good.
 - c) The new machines will arrive on the loading dock.
 - d) The woman will download her simulation data today.

4. a) He listened to the dean's opening remarks from start to finish.
c) The dean gave out the forms before he got there.
5. a) The pilot has been on hold ever since the committee approved it.
c) The lost funding is what pushed the survey to spring.
6. a) They will present only if the client moves the date again.
c) They cannot present until the client changes the date once more.
7. a) Only students with high averages got interviews at the fair.
c) Weak grades did not stop two firms from inviting him.
8. a) The council voted her into the post earlier this month.
c) The council has not confirmed her appointment yet.
9. a) The hour at which the examiner's flight is due to land.
c) Whether he is free to drive out to the airport himself.
10. a) Both the job and the degree are still open.
c) She turned the offer down in order to finish the master's.
11. a) The field technicians who visit the site.
c) Both the coordinator and the technicians.
12. a) Two of the twelve. b) Ten of the twelve. c) Three of the twelve. d) All twelve of them.
- b) The dean reached the meeting room later than he did.
d) He handed the evaluation forms out to the room himself.
- b) The ethics approval, not the money, explains the wait.
d) The committee's approval means the survey can start right away.
- b) Friday stands if the client does not move the date.
d) The client has already cancelled the Friday design review.
- b) His high grade point average is why the firms called him.
d) The recruiters refused to speak with him because of his grades.
- b) She waited for the vote before she gave out offices.
d) Most of the council opposed giving her the position.
- b) The name of the examiner he has been asked to meet.
d) The arrival gate and the length of the customs process.
- b) She accepted the consulting offer earlier in the week.
d) The people in the lab settled the question for her already.
- b) The staff of the department office.
d) The coordinator of the field technicians.

Part B – questions 13–16. One conversation.

13. a) She has her own offer from a firm outside the agreement.
c) She wants ten engineers from the firm added to the list.
14. a) All four criteria are still missing from the file.
c) Three of the four criteria are still missing.
15. a) Her own eight competencies, as her assessor does.
c) The assessor who grades her on the eight competencies.
16. a) She may begin once the firm's representative has signed.
c) The agreement must carry both signatures before she starts.
- b) She wants the office to choose a firm from its list.
d) She wants to leave a firm the office assigned her.
- b) The training plan is the only criterion already met.
d) Only one criterion, the training plan, is still missing.
- b) The training program, not the engineer who grades her.
d) Nothing at all; only her assessor writes a report.
- b) She starts on Thursday and signs the agreement later.
d) The office registers her date before anyone signs it.

SECTION B • Structure

20 pts · 1 each

Choose the option that correctly completes the sentence. Count the clauses and the connectors before you look at the options.

1. The metallurgist rejected the entire batch of steel, _____ the sulfur content exceeded the specification by a wide margin.
a) or b) yet c) for d) so
2. The retained samples from the failed lot were not photographed, _____ under controlled conditions for the required ninety days.
a) nor were they stored
b) nor stored they were
c) nor they were stored
d) neither they were stored
3. Rooftop solar output in this region peaks near midday _____ household demand peaks three or four hours later, in the early evening.
a) , b) but, c) , but d) , however
4. The dispatch team rerouted every refrigerated shipment through the southern depot _____ two of the five loading bays were still out of service on Friday.
a) however; b) ; however, c) however, d) , however,
5. The safety supervisor will not reopen the paint booth until the maintenance crew _____ the extraction system a second time.
a) is going to test b) will test c) will have tested d) has tested
6. _____ the national institute has finally recertified the reference standard, the shorter uncertainty budget applies again to every calibration certificate.
a) Now that b) By the time c) In case d) Whereas
7. The site engineer logged the internal temperature of the slab every two hours _____ the first three days of curing.
a) as long as b) while c) meanwhile d) during
8. The analyst prepares a duplicate of every calibration blank _____ one of the vials is contaminated during the digestion step.
a) provided that b) in case c) in case of d) unless
9. _____ three complete overhauls in eighteen months, the compressor returned to the same vibration peak within six weeks of each restart.
a) Although b) Despite c) Even though d) Despite of
10. The vendor's engineer answered every question at the pre-bid meeting _____ he had written the specification himself, although the client's staff had drafted it.
a) even though b) in case c) as though d) whereas
11. Nobody at the transport agency could tell the comptroller _____ only weeks before the review began.
a) why the staff had destroyed the fare records b) that why the staff destroyed the fare records
c) why did the staff destroy the fare records d) why had the staff destroyed the fare records
12. Everything in the dispute now turns on _____ the defendant can prove independent development of the compound.
a) that b) whether c) what d) if
13. _____ a nine-second silence in the middle of the crew's final checklist.
a) What the recorders preserved was b) What the recorders preserved it was
c) That the recorders preserved was d) What the recorders preserved were
14. The environmental tribunal demanded that the quarry _____ its blasting schedule with the village council every quarter.
a) will file b) file c) filed d) files
15. The 1917 statute _____ the water rights of downstream communities still governs every

new permit.

a) that protects b) that it protects c) what protects d) which it protects

16. Few readers examine the assumptions _____ the population projections in the ministry's white paper rest.
a) on that b) which c) where d) on which
17. The state registry lists 218 abandoned wells, _____ appears in the current remediation plan.
a) which not one b) not one of them c) not one of which d) that not one of them
18. The archive preserves recordings of a coastal dialect _____ last fluent speakers died in the 1990s.
a) which b) that its c) whose d) which their
19. October 1987 was the month _____ the exchange's automated system first outran the clerks who fed it.
a) where b) in that c) which d) when
20. The evidence that three independent excavations produced on the eastern terrace _____ the chronology that Hawkins proposed in 1974.
a) contradict b) have contradicted c) are contradicting d) contradicts

SECTION C · Written expression

25 pts · 1 each

One of the four underlined parts is incorrect. Circle the letter of the part that must be changed. Name the rule to yourself before you commit: if you cannot name it, you have not found the error.

1. Even though the census figures date from 2019, but the housing model still relies on estimates that predate the last recession.
a) Even though b) but c) still relies d) that predate
2. Since 1998, the geological service has released only a fraction of its core-sample inventory, the rest remains in unindexed field notebooks.
a) Since b) has released c) a fraction of d) , the rest remains
3. The cohort study met its enrollment target, however the follow-up data were incomplete for two districts when the sponsor withheld the final payment in March.
a) , however b) were c) when the sponsor d) the final payment
4. The regional utility has not published its outage statistics since 2021, nor it has responded to the formal complaints that residents submitted last winter.
a) has not published b) since 2021
c) nor it has d) that residents submitted
5. The irrigation board will release water from the reservoir once the level will exceed the seasonal minimum that engineers set for the district during the 2018 drought.
a) will release b) will exceed
c) that engineers set d) during the 2018 drought
6. Conservators began logging the humidity readings twice a day in 2016, and the registrar added a third check during technicians refitted the storage vault.
a) began b) in 2016
c) and the registrar d) during technicians refitted
7. The airline grounded eleven regional flights on Tuesday morning, apparently because of the de-icing

crews had not reported to the northern apron.

a) grounded b) on Tuesday morning c) because of d) had not reported

8. The contractor removed the last section of scaffolding by the time the safety inspectors reached the site, even though the schedule still allowed ten more days.

a) removed b) reached
c) even though the schedule d) allowed ten more days

9. Rural health posts still order the older reagent in monthly batches, and the ministry reimburses them despite the newer kit needs no refrigeration.

a) still order b) in monthly batches
c) reimburses d) despite the newer kit needs

10. The grant committee will not fund a second field season unless the team does not submit a full inventory before the deadline that the trustees approved last spring.

a) will not fund b) unless the team does not submit
c) before the deadline d) approved

11. The harbor authority suspended ferry crossings for three days last month, whereas inspectors had found a crack in the loading ramp.

a) suspended b) for three days c) whereas inspectors d) in the loading ramp

12. The consultancy describes the desalination plant as if it operates at full capacity, although the quarterly logs for 2023 show three shutdowns that lasted several weeks.

a) as if it operates b) although the quarterly logs
c) show d) that lasted several weeks

13. Although the observatory now publishes its raw measurements every quarter, few of the reviewers who cite the dataset ever examine the original researches in detail.

a) Although the observatory b) publishes
c) every quarter d) the original researches

14. Because the recorder failed, the engineers could not determine when did the pressure drop below the safety limit, nor could they reconstruct the alarm sequence.

a) Because the recorder failed b) when did the pressure drop
c) nor d) reconstruct the alarm sequence

15. The question of if the campus should build its own substation has divided the board since 2021, and no one expects a vote this year.

a) if b) has divided c) since d) and

16. The external reviewers have demanded that the department revises its assessment rubric before the site visit takes place in October.

a) have demanded b) that c) revises d) takes place

17. Even though the manual runs to three hundred pages, the maintenance section never explains in any detail that the operator must inspect before a cold start.

a) Even though b) runs c) never explains d) that

18. The foundry that it supplies the replacement castings closed two years ago, and no other plant has matched its tolerances.

- a) that it supplies b) closed c) and d) has matched
19. Once the inquiry closed, the trustees publicly thanked Professor Halvorsen, which had defended the restoration budget for almost a decade.
- a) Once b) publicly thanked c) which d) for almost a decade
20. Any facility which its ventilation record is incomplete will lose its certification as soon as the current permit expires.
- a) Any b) which its c) will lose d) as soon as
21. While the endowment has grown steadily since 1954, no clause in the trust deed records the purpose where the founders originally created the fund.
- a) While b) has grown c) no clause d) where
22. The hypotheses conflicts with the field measurements because the simulation ignores thermal expansion whenever the load exceeds the design limit.
- a) conflicts b) because c) ignores d) whenever
23. The accuracy of the readings from the three redundant probes were never in doubt until a routine recalibration exposed the bias.
- a) The accuracy b) from the three redundant probes
c) were d) until
24. Because the transcript was incomplete, the committee asked the interviewers to confirm the answers that they had given before the panel reconvened in April.
- a) Because b) interviewers c) that they had given d) before
25. Although the samples arrived late, the laboratory completed every test on time and sent the results to the analysis who had requested them.
- a) Although b) arrived c) completed d) analysis

SECTION D · Reading comprehension**20 pts · 1 each**

Two passages, ten questions each. Answer on the basis of what the passage states or implies, not on what you already know.

The Work That Nobody Opens

[1] Public spending on infrastructure divides into two activities that compete for the same money: building something new and keeping something old in working order. Engineering economists have long argued that the second returns more service per unit of currency, since timely repair lets a road keep delivering what it was designed to deliver at a fraction of the cost of replacement. Nevertheless, most public budgets lean heavily toward the first. The explanation is political rather than technical.

[2] New construction is attractive because it is visible. Officials can photograph a finished overpass and open it in a ceremony; consequently, the project attaches a dated achievement to the people who approved it. Maintenance offers no comparable moment. A culvert that crews clear before the rainy season produces nothing except the absence of a flood, and an absence enters no administration's record. Moreover, construction concentrates its reward on a scheduled date, whereas repair spreads its reward across years that may belong to a successor.

[3] The preference is expensive, as the deterioration curves that pavement engineers use make plain. Those curves are not straight lines. A surface loses condition slowly through the first stretch of its service life, and a

thin treatment in that period restores it almost completely. Once water reaches the layers underneath, however, the decline accelerates, and the job is no longer resurfacing but reconstruction, an operation several times more expensive. Deferral, therefore, does not hold the bill in place until a better year arrives; it enlarges it.

[4] Defenders of new construction raise an objection that deserves a hearing. Infrastructure, they argue, is not only a technical service but also a public statement, and a bridge can express the ambition of a city in a way that a repaved street cannot. Admittedly, the objection has force, for several structures that now serve as national symbols were justified in their day by that reasoning. Even so, it does not rescue the general case, since symbolic value is claimed for nearly every proposal and distinguishes none.

[5] A final qualification keeps the argument honest. The case for maintenance is a case for maintaining what remains useful, not for preserving everything that was ever built. Some assets outlive the demand that justified them. San Francisco, for instance, chose not to rebuild the Embarcadero Freeway after the earthquake of 1989 damaged it, and the waterfront that replaced it is widely judged an improvement. The argument therefore asks which existing works still earn their upkeep, and for most of them the answer remains repair.

1. In paragraph 1, the word 'Nevertheless' signals that the author is about to
 - a) restate the economists' argument in simpler and shorter terms.
 - b) illustrate the argument with one repair completed on schedule.
 - c) add a further reason supporting the calculation just described.
 - d) report a practice that contradicts the argument just described.
2. Which word or phrase could replace 'Moreover' in paragraph 2 without changing the meaning?
 - a) In contrast
 - b) In addition
 - c) For this reason
 - d) In other words
3. In paragraph 3, the word 'however' marks the point at which the author
 - a) adds a second example of an inexpensive preventive treatment.
 - b) explains why the early stretch of service life is unusually short.
 - c) admits that pavement engineers disagree about the curves themselves.
 - d) introduces the stage at which slow wear gives way to rapid loss.
4. In paragraph 4, 'Even so' introduces
 - a) a reason for limiting an objection the author has partly accepted.
 - b) a definition of the symbolic value that the defenders appeal to.
 - c) a further argument in support of the objection presented at the start.
 - d) an illustration of the ambition that a public work can express.
5. The passage is written mainly in order to
 - a) describe the methods engineers use to repair damaged pavement.
 - b) argue that no new infrastructure should be built until repairs end.
 - c) defend a spending priority and mark where it should not apply.
 - d) trace the history of public ceremonies held for finished public works.
6. The main function of paragraph 3 within the passage is to
 - a) compare two materials commonly used in the surfaces of roads.
 - b) explain why officials prefer projects that can be dated in advance.
 - c) supply the evidence that makes delay costly rather than neutral.
 - d) identify the districts that pay for structures no longer in demand.
7. According to paragraph 2, one reason maintenance earns little political credit is that
 - a) it is usually carried out by contractors from outside the district.
 - b) its success takes the form of an event that never occurs.
 - c) its cost is harder for engineers to estimate before the work begins.
 - d) it has to be repeated on the same date every single year.
8. According to paragraph 5, the Embarcadero Freeway is mentioned as a case in which
 - a) removing a damaged structure turned out better than putting it back.
 - b) an earthquake revealed a defect that regular inspections had missed.
 - c) a repair made on time prevented a far more expensive reconstruction.
 - d) an old structure was kept in place because of its symbolic value.
9. In paragraph 5, the word 'qualification' is closest in meaning to
 - a) restriction
 - b) credential
 - c) achievement
 - d) requirement

10. It can be inferred from the passage that an official who wanted political credit for maintenance would need to
- a) spend more on repair than on new projects each year.
 - b) commission deterioration curves for every asset in the network.
 - c) schedule every repair to finish during the rainy season.
 - d) make the damage that never happened visible to the public.

The Visit That Is Never Scheduled

[1] A post-occupancy evaluation is a systematic study of a finished building once people have moved into it: investigators read the meters, log indoor temperatures, and ask the occupants, usually by questionnaire, whether the place works. The methods are neither new nor especially demanding, and handbooks have described them for decades. What is uncommon is not the technique but the occasion, since most buildings are never revisited in any organized way.

[2] Part of the explanation is contractual rather than intellectual. Under the standard forms of appointment, the designer's obligations conclude at handover, when the keys change hands and the defects period begins. Several professional bodies have since added an in-use stage to their published plans of work, although it is normally offered as an additional service, which is to say that somebody must agree to pay for it. Few clients do.

[3] A second explanation is less often stated in print, though it is not difficult to reconstruct. A measurement that is taken after occupation is also a record of choices that identifiable people made: an orientation the architect selected, a ventilation strategy the engineer sized, a specification the client trimmed when the tender came in high. An evaluation reporting that a building overheats in summer is therefore never only a finding about the building. Professionals are not unusual in preferring assessments that arrive before a decision rather than after it.

[4] The consequence is visible in the published record. Case studies of buildings in use appear most often as award submissions, sponsored reports, and manufacturers' documentation, genres in which an unsatisfactory result has no obvious place. Buildings whose measured performance disappointed their designers are not, on the whole, written up. Researchers who compare predicted energy use with metered consumption have long noted a gap between the two; the literature that explains why particular buildings fall on the wrong side of it is, understandably, thin.

[5] It would be uncharitable to conclude that the profession is indifferent to how its buildings behave. Designers who obtain follow-up data tend to act on it, and firms that have built evaluation into their routine practice report that the exercise changes what they draw. The obstacle lies elsewhere. The instruments are adequate, the questionnaires have been validated, and the analytical procedures are settled; what is missing is a party whose interests are served by paying for the answer. On that reading, the scarcity of post-occupancy evaluation is a problem of incentives, and reforms that address the method are unlikely to reach it.

11. The passage is primarily concerned with
 - a) the energy performance of several completed buildings.
 - b) why finished buildings are rarely studied in use.
 - c) the instruments that measure comfort inside a building.
 - d) the need to redesign current evaluation methods.
12. The author's main purpose in paragraph 2 is to
 - a) identify a contractual limit on the designer's duties.
 - b) describe how handbooks set out evaluation procedures.
 - c) recommend that clients extend the defects period.
 - d) blame the professional bodies for ignoring the buildings they design.
13. According to paragraph 1, a post-occupancy evaluation involves
 - a) training the occupants to operate the building's systems.
 - b) comparing the finished building with several competing designs.
 - c) recording physical conditions and surveying the occupants.
 - d) testing the materials before the building is handed over.
14. Paragraph 2 states that the in-use stage is
 - a) required by the standard forms of appointment.
 - b) normally an optional service with a separate cost.
 - c) absent from the plans of work of professional bodies.
 - d) included automatically when the defects period ends.
15. In paragraph 3, describing professionals as 'not unusual' in this preference has the effect of
 - a) showing that other fields evaluate their own work more strictly.
 - b) tracing the reluctance to the terms of the contract.
 - c) excusing the reluctance as ordinary rather than culpable.
 - d) doubting whether the preference has ever been documented.
16. It can be inferred from paragraph 4 that the published case studies

- a) have become scarcer since awards were introduced.
b) are written mainly by independent academic researchers.
c) rely on metered data rather than on questionnaires.
d) over-represent the buildings that turned out well.
17. The author's attitude toward the design profession can best be described as
a) critical of the practice but not of the professionals.
b) openly hostile toward the profession's commercial priorities.
c) confident that the profession will soon solve the problem.
d) indifferent to how completed buildings actually perform in use.
18. By describing the literature that would explain such failures as 'understandably' thin (paragraph 4), the author suggests that
a) researchers lack the training that such studies would demand.
b) the scarcity is predictable rather than acceptable.
c) the subject has received more attention than it deserves.
d) the shortage of such studies has no plausible explanation.
19. The word 'trimmed' in paragraph 3 is closest in meaning to
a) approved. b) decorated. c) reduced. d) postponed.
20. The word 'it' in paragraph 4 refers to
a) the performance that disappointed the buildings' designers.
b) the documentation supplied by manufacturers.
c) the published record of case studies.
d) the difference between prediction and measurement.

Your profile — fill this in before you check any answer

Count how many you got right in each row. A row below 60% is a unit to reread, not a bad day.

topic	items	right / total	if this row is low, go to
G1 coordinate connectors	A1, A2, B1–B4, C1–C4	_____ / 10	U1 Grammar 1 + task set 1
G2 time & cause clauses	A3–A5, A16, B5–B7, C5–C8	_____ / 11	U1 Grammar 2 — la regla del <i>no-will</i>
G3 condition, contrast, manner, place	A6–A8, B8–B10, C9–C12	_____ / 10	U1 Grammar 3 — despite/although
G4 noun clauses	A9, A10, B11–B14, C14–C17	_____ / 10	U2 Grammar 4 — orden de enunciado y subjuntivo
G5 adjective clauses	A11, A12, B15–B19, C18–C21	_____ / 11	U2 Grammar 5 — prep + which, whose, doble sujeto
S1 noun number	A14, B20, C13, C22, C23	_____ / 5	U1 Structure 1 — incontables, plurales irregulares
S2 person vs. thing	A15, C24, C25	_____ / 3	U2 Structure 2 — familias -er/-ee/-tion
Reading 1 · transitions	D1–D4	_____ / 4	U1 Reading skill 1 — qué relación marca el conector
Reading 2 · implied detail	D15–D18	_____ / 4	U2 Reading skill 2 — lo que el texto da a entender sin decirlo
other reading skills	D5–D14, D19, D20	_____ / 12	idea principal, detalle, referente y vocabulario
TOTAL	A1–D20	_____ / 81	

★ Como leer tu total

Este simulacro cubre **solo Units 1–2**, así que el total no se convierte a la escala 310–677 del SELLI ni predice tu puntaje: mide si dominas la mitad estructural del temario que ya viste. Referencia de trabajo: **65/81 (80%) o mas** = vas al ritmo que pide un 550; **49–64** = el temario esta, falta automatizarlo con tiempo; **menos de 49** = vuelve al manual antes de seguir con Unit 3. Lo que importa no es el total sino **que fila salio baja**: esa es tu tarea de esta semana.

END OF EXAM